

marketing, strategy, and communications guy than he is as an engineer.

“Frankly, I realised that I am not a good engineer. I am good at communication, establishing relationships, and doing sales. This is when I promised myself that I will make my career in sales rather than production or R&D,” says a proud Keskar.

As an aftermath of the realisation, Keskar started looking for a job in the sales domain in the electronics industry. The first job that he managed to land in the sales vertical was with Continental Device India Limited. An India based semiconductors company, Continental Device appointed Keskar as a sales executive for Pune area. Keskar refers to this job as his entry into the semiconductors and components space in 1991.

“There was no looking back. Till now I am still serving in the domain of semiconductors and electronic components,” says Keskar. What helped him perform well and rise in his career was something that he learned in his childhood, something that he had been practising without being aware of it—the art of communicating! Keskar recalls that he had always been a big fan of how his father communicated with relatives, friends, and the colleagues he met.

“The stories he used to tell were filled with humour. I do not remember a single instance where my father was saying something and there was no humour packed in the conversation. All his conversations were to the point. I have never seen as confident a man as my father,” Keskar recalls.

Keskar loves sharing how he picked up the art of communication and networking from his father at an early age. So much so, it took him no time to make friends at new schools. While the communication skills were learnt from father, patience is one trait that Keskar inherited from his mother who was a homemaker.

“The best part about my mother is I have never seen her sad or disappointed. I realised with time that the secret to her happiness was patience and no expectations from anything or anyone,” says an emotional Keskar. Keskar remembers requesting his mother to cook Sabudana Khichdi whenever he got a chance.



Family picture with younger son Aditya holding his degree

In fact, cooking is something that he has learnt from both his father and mother. Referring to chicken curry as his signature dish, Keskar shares that he loves cooking on weekends for family.

Why mention cooking here? Because Keskar relates his professional innings to cooking a lot. He says, “Cooking requires patience like sales and building a career. It is not like you can read a recipe from the Internet or a book and prepare a dish. Making a good curry or a good career are the same. Both require you to put your heart and soul into them.”

He is also sure that listening to a lot of music from the *ghazals* genre helped him stay calm throughout his life. Keskar’s father was an aficionado of *ghazals* and, in spite of playing many sports, Keskar loved putting on the records his father owned and enjoying all type of music.

Unconditional support and decision making

The one thing that Keskar says he will always be thankful to his parents for is the unconditional support they

showered upon him in every stage of his life. Whether it was returning home late at night, marrying Sangita, or choosing to go for a diploma course, Keskar admits his parents never questioned him, but instead helped him in evaluating risks and taking the right decisions at the right time.

“There were no restrictions whatsoever from my parents even in my childhood days. I would come back from school, put aside my school bag, and run away with friends to play and return only after around 7.30 PM in the evening, and yet my parents never scolded me,” says Keskar.

He thinks his parents’ support has helped him make the right decisions. “What differentiates one from others in life is not the grades one gets or the university and college one goes to, but it is the ability to make right decisions,” says Keskar.

Keskar explains, “The point is and always will be your decision-making ability. That defines how one grows and moves forward in career. The degree and percentage may help you in getting your first job. But from the second job onwards it is always